RUTH ODUOLA

THE TRANSITIONING PHASE OF MAN'S LIFE

FOREWORD BY PASTOR ADEOLA ODUOLA



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ODUOLA RUTH

All Scriptures are taken from the KJV unless otherwise stated.

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DEDICATION

This book is dedicated to God, the source of all wisdom and knowledge.

And to every youth out there, who desires to remain burning for God at their prime, and until our Maker bids us to come home.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

My Dad and Mum, Pastor and Pastor (Mrs) Oduola, my first disciplers, thank you for your utmost support and inputs to my life, and towards this book.

Every book is a product of teamwork; my wonderful siblings, thank you for the efforts in making this book a reality.

My sister, Oduola Rachel, first worked on the manuscript, may the Lord reward you abundantly.

A team of editors, J. Mofiyinfoluwa Abokede, Oduola Rachel and Agboola Abigail worked on it. Thank you for labouring to bring out the best version of this book.

J. Mofiyinfoluwa Abokede made the cover design, I am grateful sir, may the Lord whom we serve reward your great sacrifices.

My dear friends, and everyone who encouraged the writing of this book, God bless you.

Thank you all for your inputs!

FOREWORD

This book can be encapsulated thus, "For every human being on the face of the earth, there are transitioning phases: from naivety to maturity, adolescence to adulthood and sinful phase to regenerated phase." In a nutshell, there's no saint without a past, neither is there any sinner without a future, but with a caveat, **the future lies in Christ alone.**

The book has attempted to capture the essence of coming into this planet earth, which is to please the One Who has created (formed) us, in order not to mess up the rare opportunity given to man by his Maker. If God is the Designer of man's life, of what purpose is it for the creation to be struggling with the Creator? A quick understanding of this purpose in life will go a long way in helping the creation (Man) to discover his potentials and key into the Master's plan.

Flowing from the aforementioned, this piece is equally fashioned to be a warning reminder to succeeding generations that staying on track is the will of God for your life, and it must equally reflect in the lives of your followers (disciples). Mention must also be made of the period of strength in

one`s life and when such begins to wane; implying that opportunities should not be wasted when they beckon. In other words, God is gracious but He cannot be taken for granted. Selah!

Moving forward, the book depicts the effort of a Christian Sister (a nurse by profession), who sees the imperative of making human beings created in the image of God to realize, among other things, that:

- Sometimes resilience means waking up each day, facing discomfort and challenges over and over again, yet refusing to yield your spirit because you cannot escape the responsibility of tomorrow by avoiding it today, perseverance is the key;
- Always bear in mind that your own resolution to succeed is more important than any other, determination outlasts obstacles;
- Stand on your inner conviction and not external validation.

The book without any reservations will enjoy widespread readership and circulation among the youths and adults alike.

Pastor Adeola Oduola,
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INTRODUCTION

So teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom. Psalms 90:12.

The lyrics of a hymn`s verses affirm:

Time, like an ever-rolling stream,
Bears all its sons away;
They fly, forgotten, as a dream,
Dies at the opening day.

Man's life can be likened to a day. It starts at midnight, then comes the dawn, the bright morning, the sunny afternoon; then the sun begins to set, the twilight follows suit, and finally night falls. To draw a comparison with man's life, we begin with the period of pregnancy, then childhood, youthful age, adulthood, and finally old age creeps in.

Many a time, man does not live each of his earthly days wisely until the reality of ever-rolling time dawns on him, and he realizes time is slipping away. This book compares each life to a day ∞a day long written by the Creator.

Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee: and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, and I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations.

- Jeremiah 1:5

Your story began before the entity called you was formed. Long before anyone had the thought to

conceive you, the Author of Life had a unique being in mind ∞ made specially in His image, totally different from every other being on earth and even in heaven. He started writing the story of who you were designed to become, the story of why you were made to exist, and He determined your uniqueness within this distinct plan. All you have to do is to align with His written script ∞not a plan written by yourself, for yourself, at the expense of your Creator's plan.

As you journey through this book, I trust the Lord to give you a redefinition of life and how it ought to be lived, lest you make a mess of your life and, in ignorance, live against the plan God has for you.

Ruth Oduola
Ibadan, Nigeria.

CHAPTER ONE

BEFORE I FORMED THEE

”Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee: and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, and I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations.”

— Jer. 1:5

Before your mother knew your name, God knew your days and your name. Before your first cell divided, before your heart learned to beat, long before your arrival on this earth, a script was already written; a life and a journey for you had been mapped out. The way you will navigate life, how you will bring pleasure to him, the Author of Life had drafted it.

A story: your story, not a rough sketch, not a vague hope. A fully formed narrative, complete with His purpose, with your calling, with a unique pleasure only your life could bring to His heart had been written. Which explains that the very essence of you having the opportunity to see the light of this world is to bring pleasure to Him.

Now, the tragedy is that many live off-script, and the script remains waiting and unchanged. And the Author waits too, for the actors to return to the pages He wrote before time began.

Before the knitting together of your cells to form the whole you, God said, “I knew thee.”

This should raise a question in your heart: How could He have known everything about a life yet to exist; not just a glimpse, not just an outline, but all — about you who is yet to see the light of the world?

God knows the ending from the beginning, He is all-knowing. Look at David. As a boy, barely a teenager, he tended sheep in lonely fields. No one saw a king, but God looked at that young boy and said, "I have found a man after My own heart." At perhaps, fifteen years of age, he was anointed by Samuel in the house of his father. He was about seventeen years of age when he killed Goliath. Not until thirty years, was he crowned king. Yet, the Lord had declared from the beginning what the end of this man would be. Consider Joseph, he was very young when the Lord told him of what his future would be. In between the dream and the fulfillment of his dream were the pit, Potiphar's house, and the prison. God had shown him the final page, but Joseph had to walk through the chapters he would not have written for himself. The thought He has for you is a good one, to bring you to an expected end. An end that had been written, determined and foreseen before your coming to the earth. It is not only about God’s willingness to bring you to an expected end and through all He planned

that you should do, it is also about you following him, and your willingness to trust Him through it all.

"I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty."

— Revelations 1:8

He is the Lord which is. This means He is God right now — in the present. He is the Lord which was. Before any being was created, before time itself began to tick, He already was. God has no beginning. He simply is. He is the Lord which is to come when all things would have naturally faded away, and nothing in life happens outside of His knowledge.

What is that part of your life that is or will be strange to God? Absolutely nothing! He knows ALL about you, including what you do not know about yourself.

Now, when God says before any of your cells came together or even existed, He knew you, why then do you live life off the author's direction, why do you enjoy living life against the will of the one "who is to come," who clearly understands the path your life will tread?

Have you seen a man, who argues blindly with the writer of a movie on how the movie will turn out? That's exactly the way many of us argue blindly

with the writer of our scripts. The writer of the script knows the beginning, He knows what is next, each chapter, each scene, each act, even till the end.

"Woe unto him that striveth with his Maker! Let the potsherd strive with the potsherds of the earth. Shall the clay say to him that fashioneth it, What maketh thou? Or thy work, He hath no hands?"

— Isaiah 45:9

"Surely your turning of things upside down shall be esteemed as the potter's clay: for shall the work say of him that made it, He made me not? Or shall the thing framed say of him that framed it, He had no understanding?"

— Isaiah 29:16

Bring to remembrance, Jacob, a good example of a man who strove with God and with man, infact, he was born holding the heel of Esau, his brother, and his mother called him "supplanter," which means, a wrestler. Jacob, like many always want to have their way against God's divine plan and purpose. Jacob always had his way, even if it was a long way. The striving he had only depicted the striving he always had with God.

He wasted seven years running after a girl who would not serve the God of his father, but willfully carried her own gods from her own father's house.

Before Jacob's arrival to the house of Laban, God met with him, and he made a vow to God.

"And Jacob vowed a vow, saying, If God will be with me, and will keep me in this way that I go, and will give me bread to eat, and raiment to put on,

So that I come again to my father's house in peace; then shall the Lord be my God:"

— Genesis 28:20-21.

See the silent words of Jacob, "If You will be with me" — though God had just said, "I will be with you." "In this way that I go" — not the way God had chosen, but the way Jacob himself had determined. This man was giving God the criteria to follow Him, just like you are doing too.

Which "This way" are you going, which is "I" yourself, who is leading you and not the Lord?

You are going, and leading yourself, expecting the Lord who should lead you to follow you, such a pathetic situation!

For Abraham his father, the Lord led him from His father's house to the place He showed him. Jacob here, like many, was a man who was ready to waste his time. He finished his vow by saying, then, not now, shall the Lord be my God. A man procrastinating his allegiance to His Creator!

Isaiah says, woe unto him that striveth with his Maker, that is, a man who struggles with God, a man who hardens his heart in following God's plan for his life is doomed. Are you struggling with God? Do you think your ways are better than His? No one has ever been at loggerheads with his Maker and rejoiced. To strive with the Potter is to be broken — not in the way of Peniel, which leads to blessing, but in the way of pride, which leads to destruction. No more, no less!

Just as the Lord spoke to Israel through Isaiah, He speaks to you now: O clay, you are striving with your Potter, as though by your own will you can shape something meaningful of yourself. Does the Potter lack understanding in making you the way He has? Does God have no understanding of making you the way He has done? Definitely not.

O mortal man, should you keep questioning the path Christ has led you to walk through?

Dearly beloved, God knew you before you were formed, why should you struggle further, why should you strive with your maker on this journey you know little or nothing about. The best you know about yourself, is only a glimpse of the full picture the creator has drafted out that you should walk in. Your continuous struggle and effort in navigating life on your own simply means you are despising the perfected work of God. Surrender all, and let Him lead you on this journey of life.

"Before thou camest forth out of the womb, I sanctified thee."

Now, after the knitting together in the womb, something took place, "a sanctification," meaning, a setting apart unto His good works.

"For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them."

— Ephesians 2:10 [KJV]

God had set every man apart unto good works right from the beginning of his life; however, man will not automatically function in this "good works" because there is an opposing force he was born with, "the fallen nature." The fallen nature prevents man and hinders him from fulfilling the assignment he was called to do, thereby causing him to bring displeasure to God. Only those who have surrendered unto God, can God perfect the work of sanctification upon their hearts.

No one chooses God naturally, there must be an encounter. So, if you will walk in these good works you were created for, if you will function as a craft in the hands of God, carefully and beautifully created to fit into what He had in mind right from creation, you must allow Christ deal with the old man, that fallen nature, that opposing force hindering the full manifestation of God's plan for your life; and you must fully understand who you

are in Christ Jesus and daily live in the consciousness of who He has called you to be. However, the question is, "what good works have I been set apart to do?" As a craft in the hands of the artisan, of what use is this my life?

"I ordained thee, a prophet unto the nations."

Do you know, there is a distinct vacuum God created you to fill here on earth, that no man can occupy? Do you know you have an ordination?

The prophet Jeremiah was ordained, formally separated, appointed, and granted the authority by God to be a prophet unto the nations. You have also been granted an authority to speak, to preach the gospel to the nations. The authority to rule over where you are currently placed has been vested upon you. You do not need a special approval or invitation before fulfilling God's special mandate — evangelism unto all men.

What you specifically need to know is where to fulfill your mandate, Jeremiah was called as a prophet, what am I specifically called to be?

God did not create man because He was jobless, or He wanted to explore, He simply created him unto an end, to fill a vacuum, and he must fill it. Don't desire to be a part of those who live life by chance, and have no meaningful existence to living until they die, what a wasted investment that would be on God's part.

Will you seek God's face about your ordination, your appointment and ask Him to give you a clear template or blueprint of why you were born and the reason you were born again. Ask the LORD, what assignment have you set this life apart for? What do you desire to achieve in creating me? What do I need to do to give you pleasure?

CHAPTER TWO

THE TEEN YEARS

In the previous chapter, we saw that the Author writes a script for every life before the actor ever takes the stage ∞a day long written by the Creator. Now let us turn to one of the most critical scenes in that story: the teen years.

If life were a day, then the teen years are the dawn. This is when the sun begins to rise, and light breaking through, though darkness still lingers. It is in this season that the gifts God placed inside you begin to wake up. They start stirring up, they begin to surface and they begin to ask for your attention. The very things that will shape your future start to whisper, "We are here." Including physical growth, they all begin to get visible.

You begin to question everything given to you. You start questioning the instructions given to you, back in your childhood days. Your cognitive reasoning gets widened, you seek new friends and desire new companies. You want to own your decision and take your stand.

And yet — this is deeply sad — so many young people have no idea what God has placed inside them. They walk through their dawn as if it were still midnight, not knowing that the day had already

begun. Some walk as if it were afternoon already. The choices made at that point determines the chances in the future. Zeal and passion is much in this stage, but wisdom is little. Irreversible mistakes are made most time in this stage. Many sex addicts begin at this teenage age. Many drunkards start at this teenage age.

This stage can also be likened as well to a potential energy — energy at rest, just like when a car is parked, or a machine is at rest, you have little or no idea of its capability.

As we proceed, let us check through the story of David, a teenager whom the Lord deposited great potentials into, yet he was despised by men.

"And Saul said to David, You are not able to go to fight against this Philistine. *You are only an adolescent,* and he has been a warrior from his youth.

And David said to Saul, Your servant kept his father's sheep. And when there came a lion or again a bear and took a lamb out of the flock,

I went out after it and smote it and delivered the lamb out of its mouth; and when it arose against me, I caught it by its beard and smote it and killed it.

Your servant killed both the lion and the bear; and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be like one of them, for he has defied the armies of the living God!

David said, The Lord Who delivered me out of the paw of the lion and out of the paw of the bear, He will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine. And Saul said to David, Go, and the Lord be with you!

Then Saul clothed David with his armor; he put a bronze helmet on his head and clothed him with a coat of mail.

And David girded his sword over his armor. Then he tried to go, but could not, for he was not used to it. And David said to Saul, I cannot go with these, for I am not used to them. And David took them off.

Then he took his staff in his hand and chose five smooth stones out of the brook and put them in his shepherd 's [lunch] bag [a whole kid 's skin slung from his shoulder], in his pouch, and his sling was in his hand, and he drew near the Philistine.

The Philistine came on and drew near to David, the man who bore the shield going before him.

And when the Philistine looked around and saw David, he scorned and despised him, for *he was*

but an adolescent, with a healthy reddish color and a fair face."

— 1Sam.17:33-42 [AMP]

"He looked David over and saw that *he was only a boy,* ruddy and handsome, and he despised him."

— 1Sam.17.42 [NIV]

King Saul told David, your age mates are at home playing hide and seek, you want to carry what is heavier than you. David knew that greater is He that is in him, than the host of hell put together. When his mate were playing hide and seek, he was in the bush tending his father's sheep and seeking the Lord. He had grown up in the heart, though feeble in physical appearance.

You are only an adolescent, was what was told David. Paul understanding this, said, let no man despise thy youth. God told Jeremiah, "don't say I am a child." Over and over again, God told Joshua, be strong and be of good courage. If some adolescents could be exposed to all sorts of social vices, why should David, who was around seventeen years of age, be small?

When Saul told him, "and he—Goliath has been a warrior from his youth." If Goliath had been a warrior from his youth, should David be a puppet? Notice the words of the scripture, Goliath was not a fighter, or a trainer, he had been a warrior, a

leader in war, from his youth. Train a child, not even a youth, in the way he should go, the scripture commands. You are wasting time because you think you are just a youth, just a teenager.

Timothy was a teenager, when he became a bishop. He was trained from the time he was a child.

What are you using your today to do? Your time of manifestation should not be your time of preparation.

David was prepared even though he looked unprepared. Goliath looked around and thought in his heart, is this who has come to fight this mighty me? He despised him because he was only a boy. The ex-anointed king despised him, the anti-anointed uncircumcised philistine despised him, the-close to anointing-brothers of his despised him, but the anointed David heed the words of the scripture, "let no one despise thy youth." Many will aim to despise your youth, you are the one who will not allow it.

Many adolescents and teenagers have been despised because "they don't look like it yet," but God has placed so great potentials inside of them, only if they knew who they were, like David knew, they would have stood up to start facing their Goliaths early in life.

Years after growing out of the teenage age, many are still caught in this web, they can be likened to men with the bodily structure of a youth, but with the feeble heart of a child.

Are you still afraid of drawing the sword, are you still afraid of starting what God has told you to start? I need more time, is what many keep saying, until the time is no more. Beloved grow up from being a teenager at heart, and start facing your Goliaths early in life.

CHAPTER 3

THE TIME OF STRENGTH

(THE YOUTHFUL AGE)

Having considered the teen age, the next is the youthful age. Viewing this stage through the lens of a day, the youthful years are like the bright morning. You know what the morning feels like. Your strength is at its peak and your mind is sharp, ready to face the day.

We all know that strength is at its peak in the morning and a larger percentage of people are much more productive in the morning. In fact, when you have very important meetings or activities likely to sap your strength, you fix them to the morning period, because your strength is still at its peak.

Now, imagine yourself waking up in the bright morning, and you can almost feel the possibilities of what will be done that day, because your energy is top-notch, you draft out plans for what to do, and then start out your day, you will be very fulfilled as far as that day is concerned.

That is what the youthful years are meant to be ☙ the bright morning of life. The season when strength is abundant and the day stretches out before you, full of promises.

"It is good for a man that he bear the yoke in his youth."

— Lamentations 3:27

"The glory of young men is their strength"

— Proverbs 20:29

Under the heavens, there is time and season for everything. There is a time every man will bear "the yoke" in his lifetime. It is good for a man to be attached to God in his youth to be made to follow Jesus step by step, to learn from Christ, to be disciplined, to be cut to fit into where God expects him to be. Every man has a yoke to bear, and will at a stage in life bear it upon himself. However, if at the time of his strength, he refuses to carry it, he will bear it when his strength begins to fail him. And a yoke carried in old age, without the youthful energy, is an heavier yoke.

Bring to remembrance, David; after killing Goliath, he did not go straight to the throne. He spent his twenties in the wilderness, fleeing from Saul and living in caves. He could have felt bitter, thinking life was against him. But no — he was in his bright morning. Full of energy, he was gathering a band of mighty men around himself. This was the season when he trained the warriors who later became his generals and administrators. His strength was not

wasted on comfort; it was forged in hardship. He fought battles, learned leadership, wrote psalms, and built the loyalty of the men who would help him rule. When he finally became king at thirty, he was ready — because he had spent his bright morning preparing.

Remember Joshua as well. He first appeared in the Scripture as a young man serving Moses. He led the military campaign against Amalek while Moses prayed with lifted hands. He was Moses' minister ~~—~~we might call him Moses' disciple — accompanying him up Mount Sinai. He spent his young adult years as a servant and a soldier. He was learning leadership, fighting battles, and being faithful in another man's vision. When the time came to lead Israel into Canaan, he was ready. His youth was not wasted on self-promotion; it was invested in preparation. His youthful years were his most useful years of preparation. The bright morning!

Samson's story is a warning as much as an example. His strength was legendary — killing a lion with his bare hands, striking down thirty Philistines, carrying the gates of Gaza on his shoulders. But he squandered his strength on personal vendettas and later on Delilah's lap. His prime was wasted because he never fully surrendered his strength to God. He is an example of youthful strength misused. Instead of facing his assignment early in life — learning from his parents,

sitting at the feet of the priests, being about his Father's business as Jesus was at the age of twelve — Samson was flirting with danger and showing off his power. He is a bad example that must not be followed.

Imagine a newly married lady just going to secondary school, or a mother of four just going to the university. It is possible, but more tough.

The strength of the young man is not to be wasted, it is to be invested this is the lesson Samson never learned, but David and Joshua embraced. A time is coming when you will not have this strength of yours again. This age is but a transition into another phase. What you do now, determines what becomes of you later. Your tomorrow depends on what you spend your today on. Do you expect to reap in the evening when you have not planted in the day? What I am doing today did not start today, it started when I decided to follow the Lord in my teenage age.

Do you spend your strength on that which does not matter?

To chase this unending life that keeps sapping your strength?

To chase after what is earthly and will fade away, or to chase after the eternal?

Kindly do a reflection on what you are spending your strength on.

I am not discouraging your hardwork and diligence, I am only reawakening living for eternity in you, to open your eyes to spending your strength on what will yield eternal results and, learning to let go of what will not yield eternal results. Learn as much as you can, work as much as you can; however, remember that what is not of eternal value is eternally useless.

As a young woman, do you spend your strength on men?

As a young man, do you spend your strength on women like Samson, or on social media seeking what is not lost? And you keep saying, there is time, I have the time to serve God later.

My dear reader, in the twinkle of an eye, time will pass, and the strength you once had will be in the past, only in your wishful thinking, wishing you had that energy again.

Benjamin Franklin quoted, "Never leave that, till tomorrow, which you can do today." Replacing today as your youthful age, and tomorrow as your old age, we can re-quote thus, "Never leave that, till your old age, which you can do in your youthful age."

Do not in a bid to hustle for money, suspend the time ought to be spent with God until your old age, because you are maximally useful unto God while you are young.

Never make the mistake of saying, "I will serve God when I am much older, I need to settle some things now!"

This is only a deceit from the devil to make you less useful for your Maker.

Oh, youthful one, remember *now* your creator in the days of thy youth.

Recognizable, you are making impacts in the world, the world celebrates your great feats, beautiful!

However in years to come, no one in the coming generation will remember you existed, the history you're writing in the book of time will pass away with time. Your records that are written in the chronicles of the mortals will be crushed when the world is crushed. How many great men of the past do you remember again? The impact made on earth is a temporary one that fades away with *time*, but there is a place where your impacts never fades, it is the eternal kingdom of God. Is your name known there?

Do not limit your life to planet earth. God did not create your life for temporary impacts. You were created to live for eternity.

”But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.”

— Matthew 6:33

Bear the burden while there is still strength!

CHAPTER 4

THE HUSTLING AND BUSTLING YEARS (ADULTHOOD)

If life is a day, then adulthood is the busiest part of it. If a man misses it in the youthful years, the adulthood is the age to labor in futility, working tirelessly against the Lord's will. While some may find it right at this stage, it is always difficult to.

A wrong relationship in the youthful age becomes difficult to correct. A wrong marriage in the youthful years becomes a yoke to be borne all through the person's lifetime. This is the age of working and serious labor.

Think about how a typical workday unfolds. A man leaves home early in the morning, drives through traffic to his workplace, and from the moment he arrives, he is pulled in many directions. Calls to make. Meetings to attend. Deadlines to meet. Tasks keep piling up, one after the other. He looks at the clock once — it is just past noon. He looks again, and suddenly it is evening. The day is gone. He packs up his things and prepares to go back home, wondering where the hours went.

That is exactly what the adult years feel like. They are the hustling and bustling years of life. The clock

keeps ticking, day in and day out, and for many people, the twenty-four hours we have each day never seem to be enough. There is always something demanding your attention. There is always something else to do. It is the time when what was prepared for in the youthful age is being manifested. A youthful age wasted will be reaped in this bustling and hustling stage of life.

I have seen many adults lament, lament of the mistakes they made while being young. Many adults that stopped drinking beer and chasing girls it was not because they repented, but because responsibility caught up on them.

The fire, the convictions gathered in the youthful age is also likely to be lessened and turned to empty religion in the adulthood. For a lady who just got married; while single, she could have had enough time to seek the Lord. After the first child, she goes to work in the morning, comes back in the afternoon or evening, begins cooking, in the midnight when she might want to pray, the child is crying for attention. The routine continues again the second day. From one task to the other, from one assignment to the other. Family, work, church, friends, responsibilities are seeking for attention. The desire to be a responsible man is enough to take the whole of twenty four hours from a man.

During this stage of life, distractions is at its peak. The pressure to provide, to build, to achieve, to keep up — it is relentless. And here is the quiet danger: without even realizing it, a person can unconsciously begin to exchange his faith for the search for daily bread, just in a bid to fit into the ever-rolling daily life. He starts to believe that making a living is more urgent than maintaining a relationship with God. Prayer time is swallowed up by work time. Fellowship with other believers is replaced by networking with business associates. The things of God that once mattered begins to feel like things that can wait.

Adulthood makes you realize the fact that you must keep showing up every single day. However, it shouldn't be at the expense of your internal or spiritual state. If the external state is fine, you're likely to think it is fine to move on. It is however, very saddening that many lose themselves to the "hustling" and "busyness" of this world.

This period always seem very prolonged and lengthy because there are indeed so many things to accomplish, but one day, like all other seasons come and go, this too will come and go, then old age begins to unfold. Many even try to deny it on their looks, by using various things whatsoever to

look younger, but no man will remain young forever.

However, I hope in a bid to find bread, you have not exchanged your fire. In a bid to be comfortable in life, you have not neglected your God-given purpose and strayed away to where is "trending" or where you think "suits" you. God is asking: "where are you? You are not where I have placed you."

It is very easy to slip away from where the Creator has placed you if you never had a clear vision of where you ought to be, you could as well have had a clear vision of where you ought to be, but the pressure of this ending world has swept you off your feet to Tarshish like Jonah.

God is asking a question, and He is asking you directly:

"Son, daughter, where are you? You are not where I placed you."

"Are you on the right part of destiny?"

Those words should make you pause. It is very easy to slip away from where God has placed you — especially if you never had a clear understanding of where you ought to be in the first place. But even if you once had that clarity, the pressure of life can sweep you off your feet. Like Jonah, who

was called to Nineveh but boarded a ship to Tarshish, many have allowed the currents of this passing world to carry them far from the shores of purpose.

So I ask you plainly: "Are you where God has called you to be? Are you walking on the right path?"

If yes, hold that which you have, and keep treading the path of purpose.

But if your answer is no — if you know, deep within, that you have drifted — then hear this: a turnaround is better than a wasted journey. Take a U-turn. Come back to where you ought to be. It is not too late. You cannot keep wasting five million because a million has been wasted.

Solomon had everything this world could offer. He was wealthy beyond measure. He accomplished great projects. He pursued pleasure and did not withhold his heart from any joy. Whatever his eyes desired, he went after it. He worked hard and achieved more than most people could ever dream of. By every earthly standard, he was a success.

But when he looked back over everything his hands had done, here is what he wrote:

"And whatsoever mine eyes desired I kept not from them, I withheld not my heart from any joy; for my

heart rejoiced in all my labor: and this was my portion of all my labor.

Then I looked on all the works that my hands had wrought, and on the labor that I had labored to do: and, behold, all was vanity and vexation of spirit, and there was no profit under the sun."

— Ecclesiastes 2:10-11

Do you see what he is saying? He did it all. He achieved it all. And at the end, he called it vanity. Empty. Meaningless. A chasing after the wind. Why? Because under this sun, there is no profit. The only place where reward for every good work dwells is in heaven. If your life's work is only for this world, it will not follow you beyond the grave. When Solomon was at this phase, he chased all, he did not chase the God of his fathers.

Do not waste your effort, and God's resources over you, because your life and effort will only matter in eternity if it is matched with what is on God's map for you. No matter how accomplished you might think you are, it is limited to this ending world. You are nothing better than the man who was given one talent, and refused to trade with it, but buried it in the ground. This man made no meaningful use of the talent his lord gave to him.

“For the kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling into a far country, who called his own servants, and delivered unto them his goods.

And unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one; to every man according to his several ability; and straightway took his journey.

Then he that had received the five talents went and traded with the same, and made them other five talents.

And likewise he that had received two, he also gained other two.

But he that had received one went and digged in the earth, and hid his lord's money.”

— Matt.25:14-18

Jesus told this story, and it is important to learn that you can only work while it is day. Your night is coming, when you will desire to work, but you will not be able to.

The servant who received five talents went to work and traded with them. He gained five more. The one who received two talents did the same and gained two more. But the servant who received one talent went and dug a hole in the ground and hid his master's money. He did nothing with what was given to him. He simply buried it and wasted it.

When the master returned, he settled accounts with each of them. The first two servants were commended and rewarded. But the one who buried his talent was called wicked and lazy and what he had was taken away from him.

Do not be like that man, do not waste the talent your Lord has given you, do not take lightly the gifts and graces He has embedded in you. Whatsoever you are spending your time on, that makes you neglect your God-given assignment, will only lead you astray like Solomon, and make you regret when it develops wings and fly away.

You are never wasting away, when you choose to stay in God's assignment over those attractive offers the world presents before you every day. Our Lord will soon come to demand of that which He has given to each one, will you be found a faithful steward or an unfaithful one?

EPILOGUE

Peradventure, you have just read this book, and you can sense that the time before you will not be sufficient to conquer the territories before you, or your own case is that your years are totally gone, do not fret. Our God is the God of grace, who gives grace unto all, He can restore your years like He did to King Hezekiah. All you need to do, is seek His face for mercy, and never waste the opportunity He gives unto you this time.

Shalom!

ABOUT THE BOOK

The book has attempted to capture the essence of coming into this planet earth, which is to please the One Who has created (formed) us. A quick understanding of our purpose in life will go a long way in helping the us (created) to discover his potentials and key into the Master's plan.

The book likenes a man's life to a day. It starts at midnight, then comes the dawn, the bright morning, the sunny afternoon; then the sun begins to set, the twilight follows suit, and finally night falls.

It's pages runs hot, and the truth there is undeniable.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ruth Oduola is a teacher of God's word, with a passionate desire to see young men and women burn for Him at the prime of their age. She has spoken to hundreds of students in secondary schools preached in campus fellowships as well and lead the medical team of a mission organization.

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